

Qroo Paul's Spanish Master Course

Lesson 18 Summary

In this lesson, you're learning how to combine direct and indirect object pronouns to say things like:

- I gave it to him.
- She sent them to us.
- We showed it to her.

This pattern is challenging at first, but it's used all the time in Spanish—so mastering it will unlock a huge part of the language.

Quick Review

Direct Object Pronouns (answer *what?* or *whom?*):

me, te, lo, la, nos, os, los, las

Indirect Object Pronouns (answer *to whom?* or *for whom?*):

me, te, le, nos, os, les

Only **le** and **les** are unique to the indirect set. Everything else overlaps.

Verb Focus: *Dar* (to give) – Preterite Tense

We're using *dar* in the past tense because most real-life giving happens in the past.

Conjugations of *dar* in the preterite:

- yo – di
 - tú – diste
 - él/ella/usted – dio
 - nosotros/nosotras – dimos
 - vosotros/vosotras – disteis
 - ellos/ellas/ustedes – dieron
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Word Order: ID → Verb

When combining pronouns, always use this order:

Indirect object pronoun → Direct object pronoun → Verb

Think: **I.D.** then the verb.

Examples:

- *Se lo di.* → I gave it to him/her.
 - *Me las diste.* → You gave them to me.
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Rule: Le/Les + Lo/La/Los/Las → Se

When **le** or **les** comes directly before a direct object pronoun, it must change to **se**.

✗ *le lo di*

✓ *se lo di*

Why? To avoid awkward sounds. This is a non-negotiable rule.

Placement

These pronouns can go:

- **Before a conjugated verb:** *Se lo di.*
- **Attached to an infinitive:** *Voy a dárselo.*
- **Attached to a gerund:** *Estoy dándoselo.*
- **Attached to an affirmative command (imperative):** *Dáselo.* (Give it to him.)

The subject (*yo, tú*, etc.) can go in front for clarity, but it's often dropped.

Redundant Le – A Key Feature of Spanish

In English, we never say:

“I gave him the book to Juan.”

But in Spanish, it's natural to say:

Le di el libro a Juan.

That **le** is called the **redundant le**. It's required with verbs like *dar* even if you already name the person receiving the item (*a Juan*). It appears all throughout the language with indirect object constructions.

Key Point:

You can leave off *a Juan*, but you cannot leave off **le**.

Examples to Lock It In

- *Te lo di.* – I gave it to you.
 - *Se las dimos.* – We gave them to them.
 - *¿Me las diste?* – Did you give them to me?
 - *Se lo dio María.* – María gave it to him/her.
 - *¿Se lo diste a tu mamá?* – Did you give it to your mom?
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Common Mistakes

1. Forgetting to change **le/les** to **se**

Le lo = always wrong. Must be *se lo*.

2. Reversing the order

It's always **indirect** → **direct** → **verb**. No exceptions.

3. Skipping the redundant **le** when naming the recipient

✅ *Le di el dinero a Rosa.*

❌ *Di el dinero a Rosa.*

Final Thoughts

This is one of those patterns that doesn't feel natural at first—but you **will** get it with practice. Don't rush. Focus on building the pattern slowly and consistently.

Once this becomes automatic, it unlocks a whole new level of fluency in everyday conversation.